

May 15th, 2026

Letter of Recommendation for Tarık Ziya Aykut

I am writing this letter to recommend Tarık Ziya Aykut to your program. Tarık is expected to graduate this Spring from Acibadem University's Computer Engineering Department, of which I am the head. He has been enrolled in our program since 2021.

Tarık is a diligent and responsible student. He has taken data and systems-intensive courses ranging from Data Systems, Exploratory Data Analysis, Data Science & AI, Web Programming and Cloud Computing. These courses require students to develop a comprehensive understanding of computer systems and data-driven methods, while building practical solutions using industry-standard tools and frameworks. Crucially, his expertise extends to hardware design and digital systems through courses including Computer Architecture and Microcontrollers & Microprocessors. This technical foundation is supported by math-oriented courses like Linear Algebra, Linear Dynamical Systems, and Numerical Methods. Through this coursework, he has built a solid foundation in both AI and computer systems.

In his senior design project with his teammates, Tarık is developing a web-based system for the discovery of hidden patterns in data by mapping students' course performance to their learning outcome and program outcome performance. The overall goal is to provide actionable insights about the curriculum to the faculty. The project is expected to handle bulk data and to execute intensive database operations while maintaining low latency. Within his group, Tarık's practical background in data extraction and backend automation has been highly valuable in building the system's architecture.

What makes Tarık's profile distinctive is his ability to apply this technical knowledge in real-world environments. Alongside his studies, he has gained significant professional experience as an Automation Engineer and RPA Lead, architecting enterprise workflows using UiPath and Python. Furthermore, he has contributed to applied research by implementing a deep learning pipeline for detecting cilia structures using YOLO-based models, contributing to a manuscript currently under review at *PeerJ Computer Science*. Beyond his technical endeavors, Tarık has shown exceptional leadership and communication skills through his long-standing involvement in the competitive debate community.

In summary, Tarık is an extremely motivated and practically oriented engineer with a strong sense of ownership and responsibility. I am highly confident that he will both benefit from and contribute meaningfully to your graduate program. If you have further inquiries, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Sincerely,

Prof. Dr. Ahmet Bulut

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Letter of Recommendation for Tarik Ziya Aykut

Dear Admissions Committee,

I am pleased to write this letter in support of Tarik Ziya Aykut's application for graduate study. I know Tarik as a student in the Department of Computer Engineering at Acibadem University, both through the courses he took with me and through his contribution to an applied biomedical image analysis research project under my academic supervision.

Tarik took several courses with me, including Algorithms I, Computer Networks and Social Networks, Social Networks, and Artificial Intelligence. His course grades alone do not fully represent his potential. Throughout his undergraduate education, he also maintained a demanding balance between academic study, professional work, and technical development. This gave him a more practical and mature engineering profile than what can be seen from a transcript alone.

The strongest part of my assessment comes from his research contribution. In the cilia detection and motion phenotyping project, Tarik worked on a real biomedical image analysis problem involving microscopic respiratory epithelial cell videos. His role was mainly on the technical implementation side: preparing image data, supporting polygon-based annotation workflows, experimenting with YOLO-based segmentation models, comparing model performance, and contributing to validation on independent microscopy videos.

This project required more than running an existing model. The data were limited, imperfect, and scientific in nature, with challenges related to annotation quality, model selection, and generalization beyond the initial dataset. Tarik showed that when he is given a concrete technical responsibility, he can follow the work through data preparation, experimentation, evaluation, and interpretation. This experience demonstrated his motivation for applied artificial intelligence, computer vision, and biomedical data analysis.

I am also aware that Tarik has developed himself professionally in automation and RPA while continuing his undergraduate education, including work in corporate environments such as PhillipCapital. I consider this an important part of his development: it has helped him gain professional maturity, a sense of ownership, and an understanding of reliability in real software-oriented systems.

Tarik also has strong communication and leadership skills, supported by his long-term involvement in competitive debate and student activities. These experiences help him present ideas clearly, structure arguments, and work with different audiences, which are valuable qualities in graduate study.

Overall, I consider Tarik a motivated, responsible, and practically oriented candidate for graduate study in applied artificial intelligence, computer vision, data science, or related fields. His research contribution, ability to work with real data, professional maturity, and motivation for further development make him a promising candidate. I believe he will benefit from advanced study and contribute meaningfully to applied AI-oriented academic and project work.

Sincerely,

Asst. Prof. Dr. Mehmet Serkan Apaydin
Department of Computer Science
Acibadem University